CONCEPT PROJECT · NEEDS ANALYSIS

Why Members Are Unhappy

Three root causes behind falling satisfaction at Cozy, a coworking business, and a solution for each one

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cozy can win members back by fixing three root causes, each with its own solution

Situation	Cozy rents desks and rooms in three coworking spaces to freelancers, remote workers and small teams.
Complication	In one year, overall satisfaction fell from 4.1/5 to 3.2/5, and the way Cozy handles complaints became the lowest score, at 2.7/5.
Question	Why are members unhappy, and what will raise satisfaction to 4.0/5 within two quarters?
Answer	**Three root causes, each with its own solution:** a follow-up process with call practice (changes to the log and the course Hear Them Out), space rules members can see, and set steps for Wi-Fi outages.

Concept project: Cozy and its data were made for this portfolio, based on public sources.

01 · PROBLEM

Satisfaction fell from 4.1 to 3.2 in a year, and complaint handling now scores lowest

3.2/5
Overall satisfaction, down from 4.1/5 a year ago

2.7/5
How Cozy handles complaints, the lowest score in the survey

1 in 2
Complaints in the issue log with a written next step

Three problems came up the most

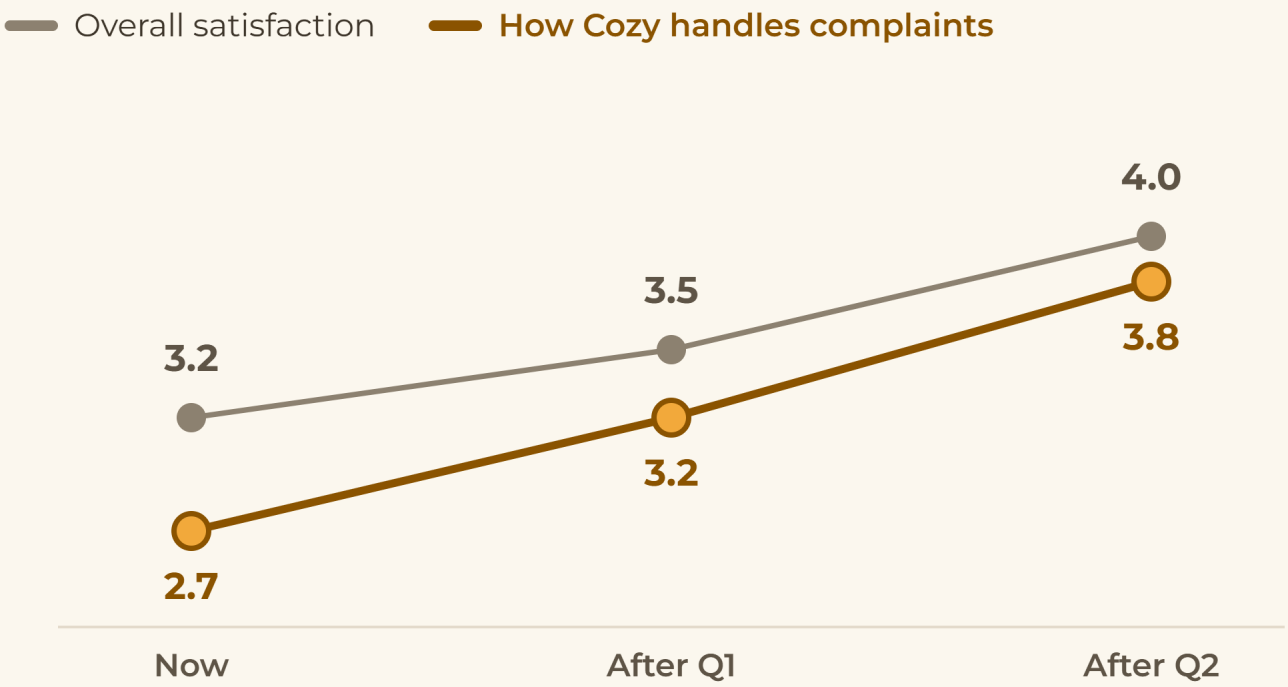
Complaint handling	Issue log
Members breaking space rules in Focus and the kitchen	Survey
Wi-Fi outages	Survey

“We’ll look into it.”
A typical reply members heard when they called to complain

Sources: Cozy’s quarterly member survey (1 to 5) and the issue log. Concept project data.

02 · GOAL

The board's goal: 4.0/5 overall and 3.8/5 for complaints, within two quarters



CHECKED EVERY WEEK

9 in 10

complaints have a dated next step, and the member hears back by that date

Now: about 1 in 2 have a written next step

Source: Cozy's quarterly member survey, from 1 (very dissatisfied) to 5 (very satisfied). After Q1 and after Q2 are targets.

Six cells and one question show where each cause sits: in the work or in skill

Environment What the work gives people	Information	Tools	Incentives
Person What people bring	Knowledge	Capacity	Motives

Gilbert’s Behavior Engineering Model, in Carl Binder’s plain-language Six Boxes.

Evidence for every cause

- Survey comments
- Issue and outage logs
- Interviews with each shift
- A visit to one space
- Public sources

THE QUESTION FOR EACH CAUSE

“Could people do it if they had to?”

Yes The fix is in the work around them: information, tools or incentives.

No It is a gap in skill, so practice helps.

Mager and Pipe’s question

Sources: Gilbert (1978), Human Competence; Binder (1998), The Six Boxes; Mager and Pipe (1997), Analyzing Performance Problems.

Complaints slip because the log asks for no date or owner, and calls take practice

EVIDENCE

A case in the issue log

Calls in Focus in the mornings
Owner: (empty)
To-do: (empty)
Open for 2 weeks

About half of the complaints in the log have a written next step.

CAUSE

Information **Tools** **Knowledge**

The log asks for no follow-up date or owner, and open cases pass between shifts by word of mouth.

On calls, staff explain the rule first and end with “we’ll look into it”.

SOLUTION

Log changes. Managers make the follow-up date and the owner required, with a reminder and a check at each shift change.

Hear Them Out. A course with call practice, in about 20 minutes.

Sources: Cozy’s issue log and shift interviews; public reviews of coworking spaces (Trustpilot, Coworker.com).

Members break space rules they cannot see, because Focus and Flex look the same

EVIDENCE

1 in 4

Noise is the top dislike of about 1 in 4 members in Deskmag's global survey.

At Cozy, members are unsure which zone they are in and when the fridge is cleared.

CAUSE

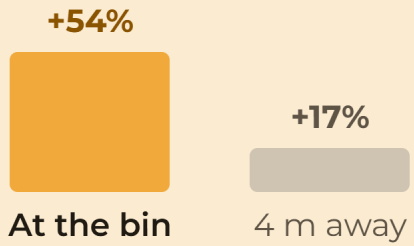
Information

The visit showed why: Focus and Flex look the same, and the rules sit in the handbook.

Members could follow the rules if they had to, so they need to see them where they work.

SOLUTION

A Focus sign, zone tape, kitchen labels, and Cozy in 60 seconds



Rise in correct recycling with the same prompt (Austin et al., 1993)

Sources: Deskmag Global Coworking Survey (2012); a visit to one Cozy space; Austin et al. (1993).

03 · ROOT CAUSE 3 OF 3 · WI-FI OUTAGES

Each shift handles Wi-Fi outages its own way, and most wait for the cause before telling members

EVIDENCE

99%

of members named internet access as the service they need most, in Deskmag's first survey.

At Cozy, each shift picks its own order of steps and its own compensation.

CAUSE

Information · Tools

Staff also switch to the backup line by hand.

Staff can do every step, but outages are rare and stressful, so the steps need to be at hand.

SOLUTION

The Wi-Fi Down card at the front desk, and an automatic switch to the backup line

- **Within 10 min**
  Tell everyone, before the cause is known
- **Every 15 min**
  Send an update
- **At 30 min**
  Call the head of operations

Sources: Deskmag Global Coworking Survey (2011); Cozy's outage log; Maister (1985); Leventhal (1980).

04 · SOLUTION

Each root cause gets its own solution, made for the people who act on it

Root cause	Model cells	Solution	For
No follow-up process or call practice for complaints	Information, tools, knowledge	Log changes, and the course Hear Them Out	Front-desk staff and managers
Space rules members could not see	Information	Signs in the space, and Cozy in 60 seconds	Members
No set steps for Wi-Fi outages	Information, tools	The Wi-Fi Down card, and an automatic switch to the backup line	Front-desk staff and operations

The log changes and the course start in the same quarter.

Model cells: the Behavior Engineering Model (Gilbert, 1978), in Binder’s Six Boxes (1998).

04 · SOLUTION · THE COURSE

Hear Them Out practices one complaint call and its follow-up, in about 20 minutes

Part 1 · The call: five decisions

- **H** **Hear** · Let her tell it, and let her finish
- **E** **Empathize** · Name the feeling and say her need back
- **A** **Apologize** · Say what Cozy got wrong, keep names private
- **R** **Resolve** · One next step, with an owner and a day
- **D** **Diagnose** · Keep the case open until she says it worked

If a decision goes wrong, Sofia scores Cozy in the survey a week later, then a debrief rewinds the call to the first miss.

Part 2 · After the call

- Log the case in Cozy Desk
- Hand it over at shift change
- Call Sofia back on the day promised
- **Sofia scores Cozy 5/5**

BUILT FOR JANE, THE PERSONA

Each part takes 15 minutes or less, progress saves after every step, and it works on a phone.

Sources: Disney Institute, HEARD; Moore (2017), Map It; Merrill (2002); Knowles et al. (2015), The Adult Learner.

05 · MEASURING

Each solution has its own measure, and the quarterly survey checks them together

Solution	Measure	When
Hear Them Out	First-try results for each step of HEARD	In the course
The follow-up log	9 in 10 complaints with a dated next step, met on time	Every week
Signs and Cozy in 60 seconds	Complaints about the shared space, by zone and kitchen	Every week
The Wi-Fi Down card	Minutes to the first notice, and the same compensation	Every outage
All three solutions	Complaint score and overall satisfaction	Every quarter

Reading the results together

The log reaches 9 in 10, but the score stays at 3.2/5: staff follow up on time, so check whether the options they offer meet members' needs.

The score rises, but the log stays below 9 in 10: check the handover step and the reminders.

Data: the course results, the issue log, the outage log and Cozy's quarterly member survey.

Thank you

Three root causes, and a solution for each one.

The full case study and documents: duongngochongson.vercel.app

Try the course: hear-them-out.vercel.app